men with him, the major once again headed back to the track junction from where he made it to Phobrang on 5 November. The next day IAF aircraft dropped supplies and eventually all the men made it back with no further casualties.

Nullah Junction, Hot Springs and Tsogstsalu would remain under Indian control. In all, 5 Jat had 58 killed and over 200 men hospitalized, with the bulk of them returning to active duty within weeks. Despite being split into miniscule sub units the battalion had performed exceptionally well.

THE PANGONG-SPANGUR SECTOR

1/8 Gorkha Rifles, having de-inducted from the Galwan and Changchenmo Valley during the second week of October, were at full strength (minus one company) in the Pangong-Spanggur theatre of operations, and also the mainstay of 114 Brigade for the defence of Chushul. Referred to as the Middle Sector, it included both the brackish water lakes and the watersheds that surrounded it on all sides, creating a bowl-shaped tract. To the north lay the mountain range that separated the Pangong Tso from the Changchenmo, their southern sides sloping towards the lake. Towards the east, were the Pangong and Rezang ranges, running north to south, more or less forming the International Boundary. To the west and south was the Ladakh Range that separated the waters of the Spanggur Tso from the waters of the Indus, which flowed from east to west further to the south. The lakes themselves were at 14,000 feet, while the Pangong and Rezang ranges had a maximum altitude of 19,750 feet.

On the northern bank of the Pangong Tso, facing the Chinese to the east, was the Srijap Sector while on the southern side of the lake, touching the International Boundary was the Yula Sector. The Indians had been using assault boats that had been flown in by the IAF to maintain the line of communication. The point of embarkation was Tokung, the 1/8 GR Battalion HQ, where the relatively small Chushul Chu flowed into the Pangong Tso, while on the northern shore the boats would dock at Srijap East and also on the southern shore at Yula I and Yula II. Though Phobrang, also on the northern side of the Pangong Tso, had been linked to Chushul by a motorable road, ferrying supplies and ammunition to Srijap further to the east from the road heads was not feasible. The Chinese, on the other hand, had built a road from the Khurnak Fort linking their positions in the Srijap area to the rear as was their usual practice. This road had been completed on